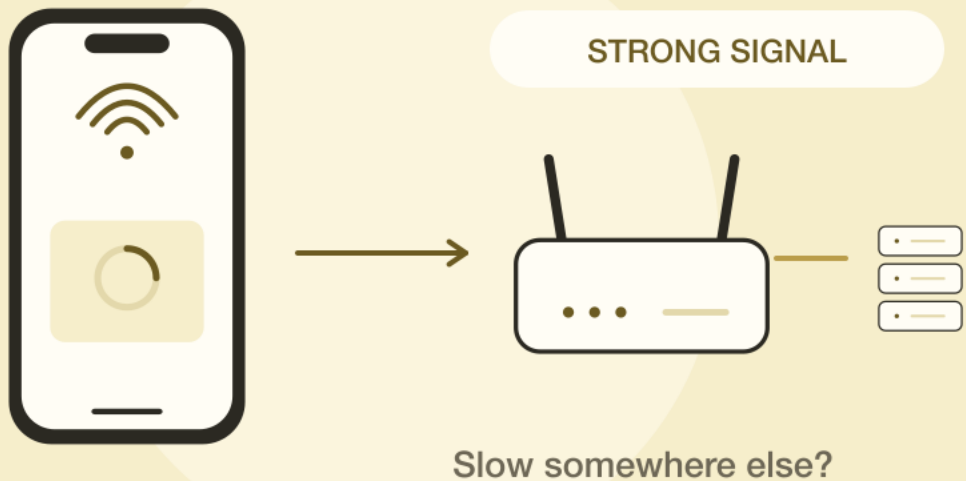


Full bars. Still buffering.

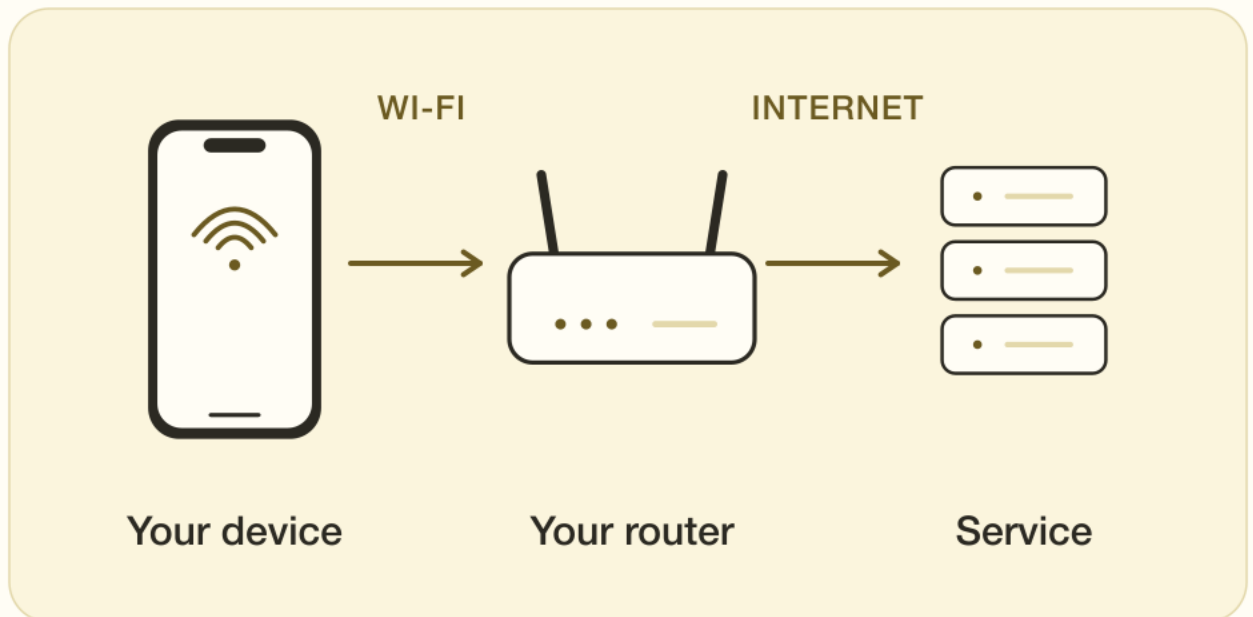
The bars describe your signal to the router.
Your video has a longer trip.



TWO DIFFERENT CONNECTIONS

Wi-Fi is one link. Not the whole trip.

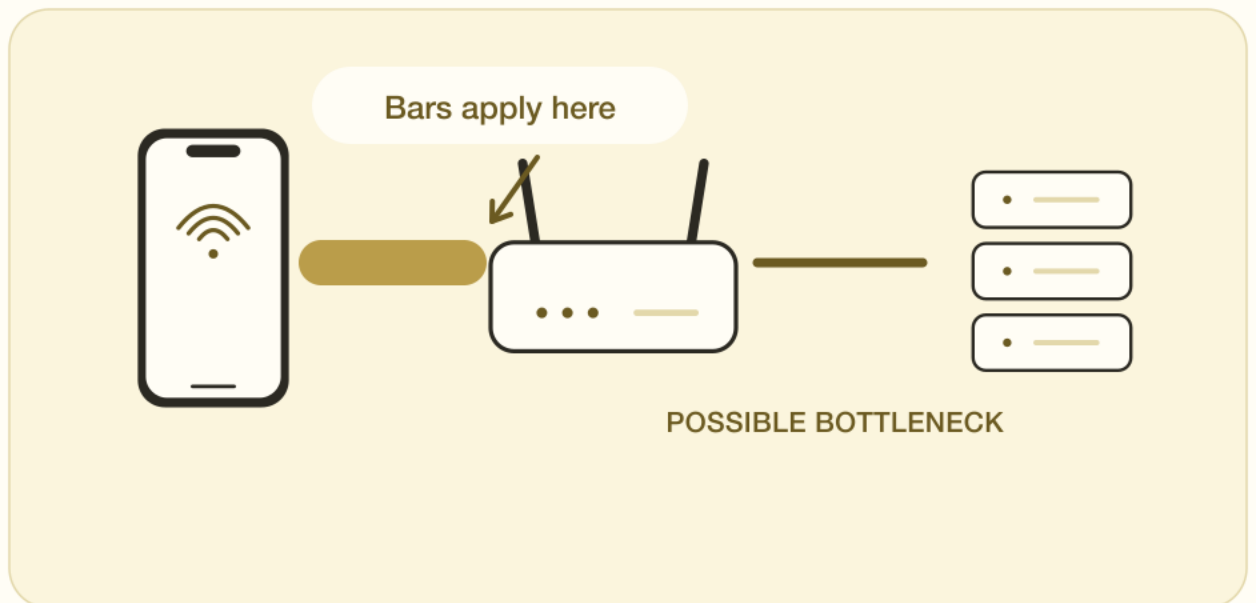
Wi-Fi connects your device to a nearby router.
The router uses your internet provider
to reach the service you want.



WHERE THE BARS APPLY

Strong first link. Slow next link.

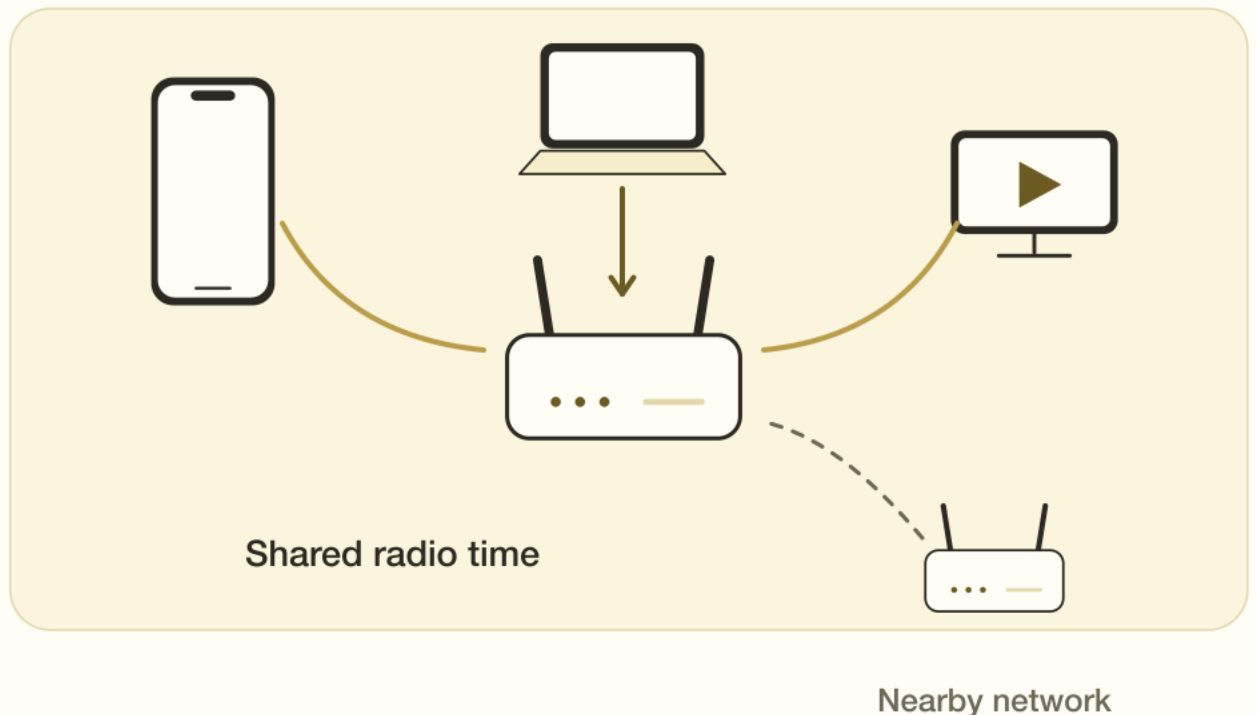
Your phone can hear the router clearly
while the connection beyond it is slow.



Wi-Fi shares the air.

Devices share the radio channel.

Busy devices and nearby networks can add waiting, even when the signal is strong.



Your plan is shared too.

A video call, streaming and a large update all use the connection coming into your home. Heavy use can leave less capacity for your device.

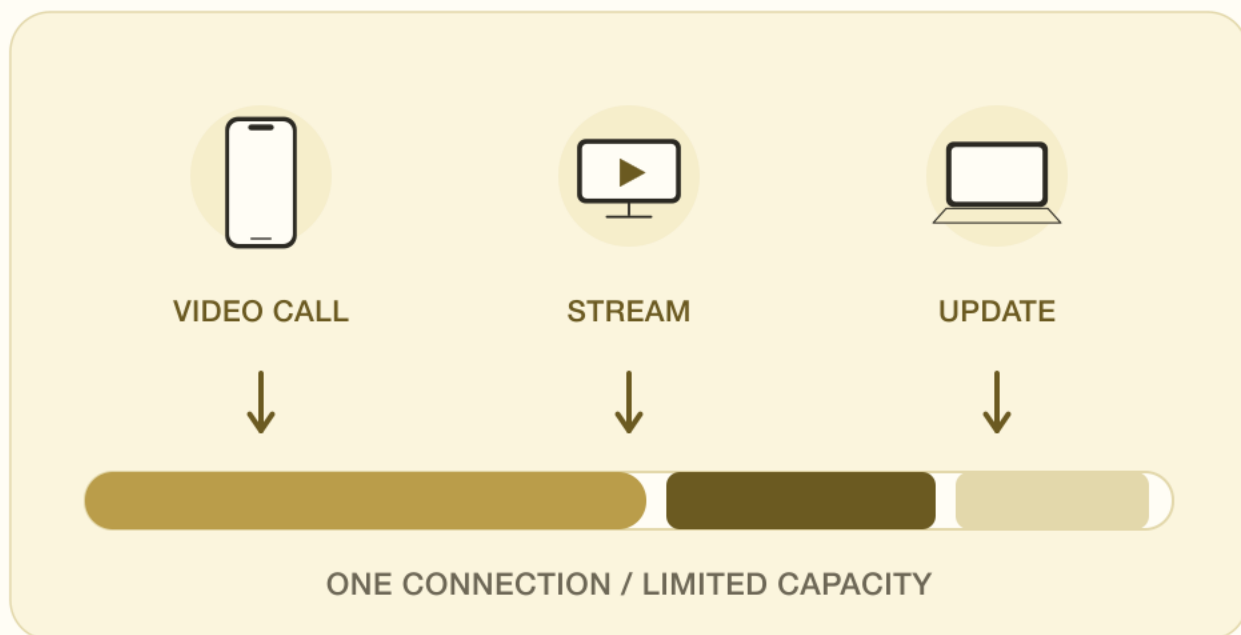
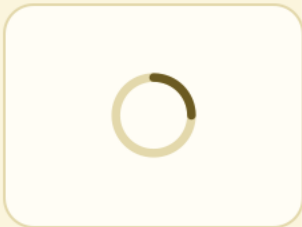


Illustration of shared demand, not measured usage.

One slow app? Or everything?

If only one service is slow, its servers
or that app could be the problem.
Your device and software can also matter.



App A

Still loading



App B

Working normally

Fictional app comparison.

Test. Compare. Narrow it down.

Use the same device in the same place.
Pause large downloads while you compare.

01 Try another service

Is it just one app?

02 Run a speed test

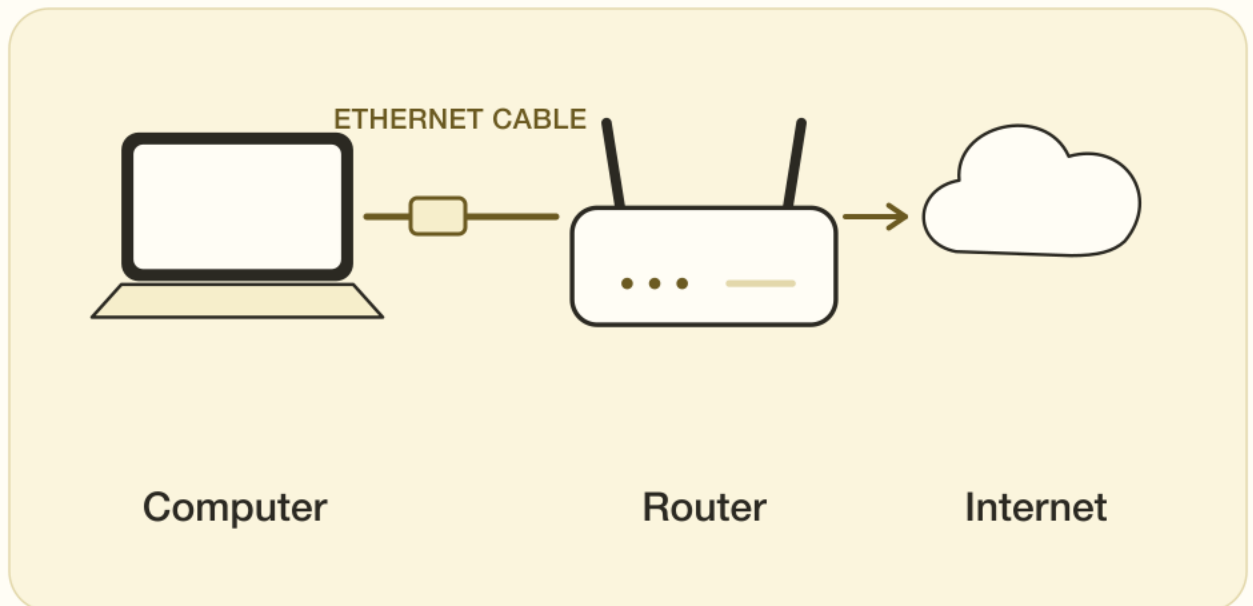
How fast is this test path?

03 Compare another device

Does the issue follow this device?

Try a cable if you can.

A wired connection skips the Wi-Fi radio link.
Fast by cable but slow by Wi-Fi suggests
a wireless issue. It is a clue, not proof.



If both tests are slow, more checks may be needed.

Bars: signal. Speed: whole trip.

Full bars are useful information.
They are not a guarantee of fast internet.



SIGNAL BARS

Your device to the router



SPEED TEST

The whole tested path

First: another app, a speed test, paused downloads.